



Moblin.org

What is it?

An open source initiative, in partnership with Intel, to build a mobile entertainment and communications platform for use on tablet PCs and Intel-based Mobile Internet Devices (MID). Moblin.org hosts projects that will provide the kernel, multimedia applications, power management framework, etc. for open source projects.

Who is behind it?

Intel has mooted this project to work in collaboration with programmers from Canonical, Red Flag MidLinux, and Pepper Linux. Independent programmers can also contribute their development to these projects and build applications for these devices.

Why is it a good thing?

Moblin.org aims to ensure the interoperability of the various components used in open source platforms of the MID genre. It will provide all the source code and binary images that can run on these devices for developers to build on.

How does this help?

Developers, with access to shared information, can now learn of new developments and quickly build applications for the platform of their choice. For Intel, this move takes them closer to open Web standards while partnering with Linux architects who even participate in kernel development.

Where does this project intend to go?

It is hoped that the project will be a technology incubator for a lot of MIDs and handhelds that will be produced in the next three years.

When will the project be completed?

It is an ongoing endeavour and will not focus on deadlines. Intel says Moblin.org will only host the source code and tools such as documentation and mailing lists for programmers to use.



helpful feature in the software.

Well-known security firm Secunia rated the flaw “highly critical.”

Some are pointing out the silliness of those who do not update their anti-virus on a regular basis.

If you’re stuck with a 2006 version in its original

form (without having updated it), the fault lies with you—or so a lot of people would have you believe. But does the LiveUpdate program itself—tell users that updates are “critical”? That your computer might become vulnerable if you don’t use it? Does even the installation guide, or the help file, mention explicitly the following: “It is of critical importance to use LiveUpdate on a regular basis; failure to do so could put your computer at risk”? It does not.

What if your car manufacturer suddenly told you you’re accident-prone because you didn’t service it often enough? On the other hand, some commentators are taking a negative view of Symantec in general, saying the news of the vulnerability does not surprise them. We will not go one way or the other: it’s up to you to use Symantec’s products or pay for a different anti-virus or use a free one. But do remember to update it regularly, and this is the 3,428th time we’re telling you this. Our only comment is that the vulnerability hasn’t done good to the company’s already-diminishing reputation.

be the anti-virus, you’d believe. Even if not you, many people would—they do consider they’re fully “safe,” “secure,” and such—if they have that nice yellow icon in the taskbar, indicating protection from all that’s bad on the Internet. You have the icon, nothing gets into your computer. It’s that simple—for many people. It turned out in the second week of August there’s a major bug—with two ActiveX controls, to be precise—in the 2006 versions of Norton Internet Security, Norton AntiVirus, and others, including some 2005 versions. 2005 we can understand. But 2006 is more difficult to understand—you updated it just a year ago, and it’s already gone to the bad. Symantec warned users, “This error could allow an attacker to crash IE, or possibly run (code) with the rights of the logged in user.” The security advisory also mentioned that the attacker would first have to sway the user to navigate to a specially-crafted Web site. (Which isn’t all that hard, we should remind the more Net-savvy amongst you.) The answer is to run LiveUpdate, a rather

SO WHEN?

Déjà Vu

This is just about something we noticed in the news. November 2005, much of the Web—at least the part we frequent—was abuzz with: “Samsung challenges Japanese fuel cell tech.” The report was that Samsung had developed a prototype notebook fuel cell that could last twice as long as rival systems—and it was lighter and slimmer. Some speculated the cell would be in the market by 2007.

December 2006: “Samsung has made significant progress towards the battery life problem, demonstrating a 12,000 Wh fuel cell for its Q35 laptop.” It used Direct Methanol Fuel Cell technology. Speculators speculated it could come to market by end of 2007.

Now here’s 13th August 2007: “The Direct Methanol Fuel Cell, recently showed off on a Q35 Samsung laptop in Korea, provides total energy storage of 12,000 Wh.

12,000 Wh... where did we hear that before? Hark back two paragraphs.

One analyst is now saying fuel cell technology is on the brink of becoming a very promising option for the future, *once final engineering work has been completed.* (Our italics.)

We’re as befuddled as you are. Disclaimer: if Samsung does do something revolutionary, don’t tell us we predicted something to the contrary—we aren’t. We’re just wondering about how the same news is coming out every year with clockwork regularity.

3rd October 2006: “Consumers will have to wait a few years before they (get) fuel cells, Nokia said.” It was something about the supply chain. But it could also be about the final engineering work. Hark back two paragraphs. ☒